

Active and Passive Voice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Year 6 English — Grammar

ACARA v9.0: AC9E6LA06

Learning Intention

I am learning how the careful choice of active or passive voice changes the focus and meaning of a sentence.

Success Criteria

- I can identify active and passive voice.
- I can change a sentence from active to passive.
- I can explain why a writer chooses passive voice.

Who's Doing It?

Active voice: the subject does the action (The dog chased the ball). Passive voice: the subject receives the action (The ball was chased by the dog).

Worked Example

Active: The chef cooked the meal.

Passive: The meal was cooked by the chef.

(Subject and object swap places; 'was' + past participle.)

Part A — Warm Up

Circle the passive sentence: **The dog bit the mailman. The mailman was bitten by the dog.**

True or False: In passive voice, the subject performs the action. _____

Identify the agent in: 'The cake was eaten by Tom.' _____

Part B — Core Skills

Change to passive voice: *The council built the new library.*

Change to active voice: *The window was broken by the storm.*

Identify active or passive: *The trophy was awarded to the winning team.* _____

Explain one reason a writer might use passive voice instead of active voice.

Word Bank

active voice • passive voice • agent • subject • object • was • by • past participle

Working Space — Write the Same Event in Both Active and Passive Voice

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Part C — Challenge: The News Report

A Year 6 student wrote a news report: "The trophy was presented to the winning team by the mayor. A large crowd gathered to watch."

Q8. Identify which sentence is passive voice and which is active voice.

Q9. Rewrite the passive sentence in active voice.

Q10. Explain why the student may have chosen passive voice for the trophy sentence, focusing on what the sentence emphasises.

Answer Key — Part A

A1: The mailman was bitten by the dog.

A2: False — in passive voice, the subject receives the action rather than performing it.

A3: Tom.

Answer Key — Part B

B1: The new library was built by the council.

B2: The storm broke the window.

B3: Passive.

B4: A writer might use passive voice when the doer of the action is unknown, unimportant, or when they want to emphasise the action or the receiver rather than who did it.

Answer Key — Part C

C8: "The trophy was presented to the winning team by the mayor" is passive. "A large crowd gathered to watch" is active.

C9: The mayor presented the trophy to the winning team.

C10: The student likely used passive voice to put the focus on the trophy and the winning team (the more newsworthy part of the event) rather than on the mayor, who is less important to the story's main focus.

I Can Checklist

☐ I can identify active and passive voice.

☐ I can explain why a writer chooses passive voice.

☐ I can convert between active and passive voice.